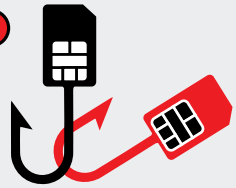
THE MODUS OPERANDI

1



Criminals procure fake SIM cards to make calls that cannot be traced back to them

2



They bait victims with e-mails, SMSes, ads on Facebook, WhatsApp and Telegram chats

3



They get targets to click links, reveal PINs, download remote access/ screen-sharing apps or scan QR codes

4



This allows crooks to hack accounts or gain direct access to a person's bank account

5



The fraudster transacts on the victim's behalf and moves the money to a mule account

THE WFH SCANDAL

You get job offers to complete a task. Payment shows up on a fake crypto wallet/ UPI link, but can't be withdrawn. Meanwhile, crooks ask you to invest money, after which the link disappears

DIGITAL LENDING APPS

They first hook you with loans at cheap rates but then use exploitative practices to recover the money, which include threats to upload your morphed pictures online

THE SIM CARD SWAP

Your phone network goes blank and you get a call saying you have to press a number to regain it. If you do, you activate the SIM card that the cyber thief has swapped

FAKE BPO OP

Criminals sitting in India purport to be from the US Social Security agencies and dupe American citizens, saying their social security numbers have been compromised and to convert their money into crypto or gift coupons

THE SEXTORTION BIZ

Crooks approach you on FB, luring you onto a WhatsApp video chat. They then use DeepNude tools to morph your images, and blackmail you